



Fig. 2: (a) Original State bank website for Internet banking, and (b) mimic website example

5. Make sure the wallet provider has a customer support wing that can help in case of fraud.

6. Do not use the same password for all accounts.

7. Avoid installing third-party software shown on pop-up advertisements while using apps.

8. Double-check the details while transferring money. Even if the wallet has a possibility of threat, it is still safer than using a credit/debit card for online transactions.

Threats in Internet banking

Even though banks provide a lot of security measures, online banking services (NEFT/RTGS) are not free from the menace. Security threats include phishing, spyware and adware, viruses, trojans and key-loggers, among others.

Phishing and spam emails look like these have been sent from the bank itself, and ask for personal details such as usernames and passwords.

Spyware and adware are a special type of software created by hackers to collect sensitive information. These track your Internet habits and interests, and provide the same to marketing companies. This is how you end up with spam in your inboxes.

A virus attaches itself to a program by clubbing with another program in the computer by using different resources of the computer. An email virus is a special type

of virus that gets embedded in an email and when you open the email, it replicates your information and distributes it.

A trojan can also be categorised as virus but it does not replicate itself and does not need any particular program to attack. It is a destructive program that acts as a harmless application, such as a helpful software claiming to get rid of unwanted software or virus. Instead, it attacks your information and makes it vulnerable.

Key-loggers log all user activities on the computer by capturing every keystroke. The sensitive information is then captured and accessed by fraudsters to attack users.

Some security measures that you can take while using Internet banking are:

1. Always access the registered website of the bank. Do not follow any links sent in emails.
2. Beware of phishing attacks. Do not reply or disclose any sensitive information like username and password in response to emails claiming to be from your bank. Banks never ask for sensitive details.
3. Protect your password, and do not write it down. Always use strong passwords that are difficult to hack. Change your password regularly—at least once a month.
4. Install a good antivirus on your system for protection from virus and spyware.
5. Check for <https://> instead of

<http://> in your browser address while using Internet banking.

6. Avoid using public computers or Internet café computers for accessing bank accounts. If you need to do so, use the onscreen keyboard for typing out the username and password, check for unnecessary background programs, clear history and cache after logging out, and hide the password while typing it out.

7. Do not click on unwanted ads on emails or other websites.

Mobile security

A lot of us use phone banking these days, but most of us do not check the permissions we give while installing apps on our mobiles. Our mobile phones contain very sensitive information, and giving permission to access these means making it easier for criminals to hack our systems. Always be careful while accessing bank or financial data through mobile phones.

1. Do not use the same password for wallets and bank accounts.
2. Use dynamic password-generation apps for creating passwords for bank accounts.
3. Check while granting permissions when installing apps.
4. Avoid third-party software that pop up while using other apps.
5. Always log out after accessing your account.
6. Do not save usernames and passwords on the app. **EFY**